



Fictionalized Settings

A fictionalized setting is based on a real place (or places), but at the same time also a distinct fictional entity, such as the hybrid city of San Fransokyo in the film *Big Hero 6*. The main advantage of such a setting is that it allows for both the inclusion of familiar real world elements as well as extensive fictional customization. The Storyteller can draw on an actual place for inspiration and keep any parts of that place that she likes – maps, landmarks, historical events, general ambiance – while at the same time also leaving her free to add, remove, or alter anything she likes to suit her story. The result is a place that's at once very familiar, and yet at the same time utterly alien...a perfect way to represent the World of Darkness.

Example: Pete is running a game for a group of friends, and since the group lives near Philadelphia, he decides it would be convenient to use it as a setting since they're all familiar with it. However, he also wants to make it his own, as well as change some parts of it to suit his story better. He decides to create a fictionalized version of Philadelphia, which he calls Liberty City. Most of the city's history is the same, from its role in the Revolutionary War up to the present day, but he decides to add to the skyline a bit, putting up several huge corporate headquarters and letting the players know the city is experiencing a high-tech boom that has revitalized downtown.

Thinking on it a little more, he also tells the player the city is host to a number of large cemeteries full of ornate old mausoleums, in the style of New Orleans. When the players ask why, he simply smiles and tells them they'll find out soon enough. All of a sudden a place they knew well got a whole lot more ominous and sinister, which is exactly what he had in mind.

elements of **Changeling** like Bedlam or the Undoing. If the players are the only changelings in town, it's also worth asking if they really know what they are, or if they have just been struggling to put it together on their own. It may also be useful to determine if there are any local Prodigals the characters are aware of, whether they're ghosts the sluagh are familiar with or still stranger creatures in the night.

Story Time

Once characters are created and a setting established, it's time to begin telling stories together. Whether the game is a one-shot session, a story spanning a half-dozen sessions, or a years-long chronicle, certain common units of measurement are used to help players and Storytellers alike keep track of time and organize stories. Chapter Five introduced some of these